Name: .....
ID: .....

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الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
EL117
Academic Writing
All Branches
Makeup- KSA
MTA Exam
2025-2026 /Fall
Date: 18 Nov. 2025
2:30 – 4:00

Section: _____

Number of Exam Pages: 9 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** **1.5 hours**

INSTRUCTION

There are THREE sections in this exam paper:

You are required to answer ALL the sections.

1. In section 1, apply the learned skills for writing focus by answering analytical questions related to unity, cohesion, structure, and mechanics of writing.
2. In section 2, choose only one topic and outline a four-paragraph essay.
3. In section 3, write a standard essay: start with an introduction, develop well-written body paragraphs, and end with a concluding paragraph. After you finish writing your essay, edit and proofread it paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
4. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
5. Devote 5 minutes for reading through the whole paper and making the appropriate selection of questions.

Question Number	Minutes	Mark allocated (per question)	Earned Mark	Marker's Initials & Signature
Section I: Writing Focus & Editing	20	10		
Section II: Essay Outlining	15	5		
Section III: Essay Writing	55	15		

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Total in Figures		30		
Total in Letters	90 Minutes	Thirty Marks		

Section	1	Writing Focus & Editing	10 POINTS	20 MINUTES

Choose the right answer from a, b, c, or d. *(1 point each)*

1. Which sentence best combines the pairs of clauses to form a correct sentence?
"He wanted to attend the conference. His supervisor advised him to finish the project first."

a. He wanted to attend the conference, and his supervisor advised him to finish the project first.
b. Although his supervisor advised him to finish the project first, he wanted to attend the conference.
c. He wanted to attend the conference; however, his supervisor advised him to finish the project first.
d. Both b and c

2. Coordination conjunctions combine two clauses. What relation does the sentence below show?
"I enjoy reading novels, and I also like writing short stories."

a. Addition
b. Choice
c. Difference
d. Result

3. Which sentence best combines the pairs of clauses to form a correct sentence?
"The scientist conducted several experiments. The results were inconclusive. She decided to revise the methodology."

a. The scientist conducted several experiments, and the results were inconclusive, so she decided to revise the methodology.
b. Although the results were inconclusive, the scientist conducted several experiments and decided to revise the methodology.
c. The scientist conducted several experiments; the results were inconclusive; she decided to revise the methodology.
d. The scientist decided to revise the methodology after the results were inconclusive, she conducted several experiments.

4. Choose the revision that has correct subject-verb agreement in the following sentences.
"The series of lectures on modern architecture _____ scheduled for next month."

a. is
b. are

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c. were
d. have been

5. What do the underlined words in bold do?
"She studied hard. **Therefore**, she passed the exam with flying colors."
a. a. Show contrast
b. Show result
c. Show a reason
d. Give an example

6. Which of the following is the correct description of the following clause?
"Although the experiment was successful."
a. run-on sentence
b. fragment sentence
c. comma splice
d. complete sentence

7. Which of the following sentences uses commas correctly?
a. The study focused on language acquisition reading comprehension and writing skills.
b. The study focused on language acquisition, reading comprehension, and writing skills.
c. The study, focused on language acquisition, reading comprehension and writing skills.
d. The study focused on, language acquisition reading comprehension, and writing skills.

8. Read the following introductory paragraph, and then select the most appropriate thesis statement.
Climate change is one of the most pressing issues facing the global community today. Rising temperatures, extreme weather events, and ecological disruptions are affecting both human societies and natural ecosystems. .....

a. Addressing climate change requires urgent, coordinated action to mitigate environmental, social, and economic consequences.
b. Climate change is a distant problem that does not affect most countries.
c. Human activity has no influence on climate change.
d. Climate change is an inevitable natural process with no solutions

9. Read the following paragraph, and then select the most appropriate topic sentence.
..... Volunteering provides numerous benefits to both the community and the individual. It allows people to gain new skills, meet others with similar interests, and feel a sense of accomplishment. Communities benefit from volunteers who help organize events, tutor children, or provide essential services. By volunteering, individuals can also improve their resumes and develop professional experience while contributing positively to society. In conclusion, volunteering is rewarding in multiple ways.
a. People only volunteer to improve their resumes.
b. Volunteering is beneficial for both individuals and communities.
c. Communities should hire more employees.
d. Volunteering is too time-consuming

SOLUTION PT

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10. Read the paragraph below, then choose the best concluding sentence.
Reading fiction books can be both entertaining and educational. They allow readers to explore new worlds and perspectives while improving vocabulary and comprehension skills. Stories often convey valuable life lessons and insights into human behavior. Moreover, discussing books with friends or classmates encourages critical thinking and reflection. .....

a. In short, reading fiction books enriches both the mind and imagination.
b. To conclude, books can sometimes be found in libraries.
c. Fiction books are printed on paper.
d. People should only read textbooks.

Section	2	Outlining	5 POINTS	15 MINUTES

Outline ONE of the following topics by filling in the graphic organizer below. ***(5 points)***

1. *"Patience is a key to success; those who wait wisely often gain more than those who rush."* Write a narrative essay describing a personal situation in which being patient helped you achieve a positive outcome. Include detailed descriptions of the context, your thoughts and feelings, the challenges you faced, and the results of your patience. Support your essay with specific examples.

2. Write a cause-and-effect essay exploring the significance of being an active and productive member of the community. Investigate the various reasons behind the importance of productivity, such as personal growth, community engagement, and societal impact. Provide concrete examples and anecdotes to illustrate each reason.

Introductory Paragraph: ***(1.5 point)***

Hook/Opening statement:

_____
_____

Thesis statement:

_____
_____

Body Paragraph (1): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (1):

_____
_____

Major supporting details:

_____
_____

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Body Paragraph (2): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (2):

Major supporting details:

Concluding Paragraph: ***(1.5 point)***

Restatement of the thesis:

Final comment:

Section	3	Essay Writing	15 POINTS	55 MINUTES

Write a four-paragraph essay (300-350 words) on the same topic that you have outlined in the previous section. **(15 points)**

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